

Jason Cooper

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Letter of Recommendation

To the Admissions Committee,

I am writing in strong support of Katherine S., who has trained under me at Parkside Dance Academy for four years and is among the most quietly determined dancers I have taught. When she arrived her confidence lagged behind her ability. This year it finally caught up, and the result is a young artist who can hold a line, listen to a score, and make an audience lean in.

She danced a soloist variation in our production of Appalachian Spring and met a professional standard of musicality and placement. The choreography asked the soloists to read as individuals without breaking the picture, and she did exactly that, holding the austere line the work demands while still phrasing the music as her own.

She takes correction the way serious dancers do, without flinching, and with the next attempt already better. In a studio that treats standards as non negotiable, she has never once asked for the easier version of anything. That habit, more than any single step, is what tells me she is ready.

I recommend her without reservation. She is ready for the demands of a conservatory program, and she will repay your investment with exactly the kind of work that cannot be faked. I am glad to speak further if it would help your deliberations.

■ ABOUT THE RECOMMENDER

Jason Cooper holds a BFA from the Arden Conservatory of the Arts and is the lead choreographer and a senior instructor at Parkside Dance Academy, where he teaches about sixty dancers across six levels and stages the winter and spring showcases.

Jason Cooper, BFA

Choreographer and Instructor